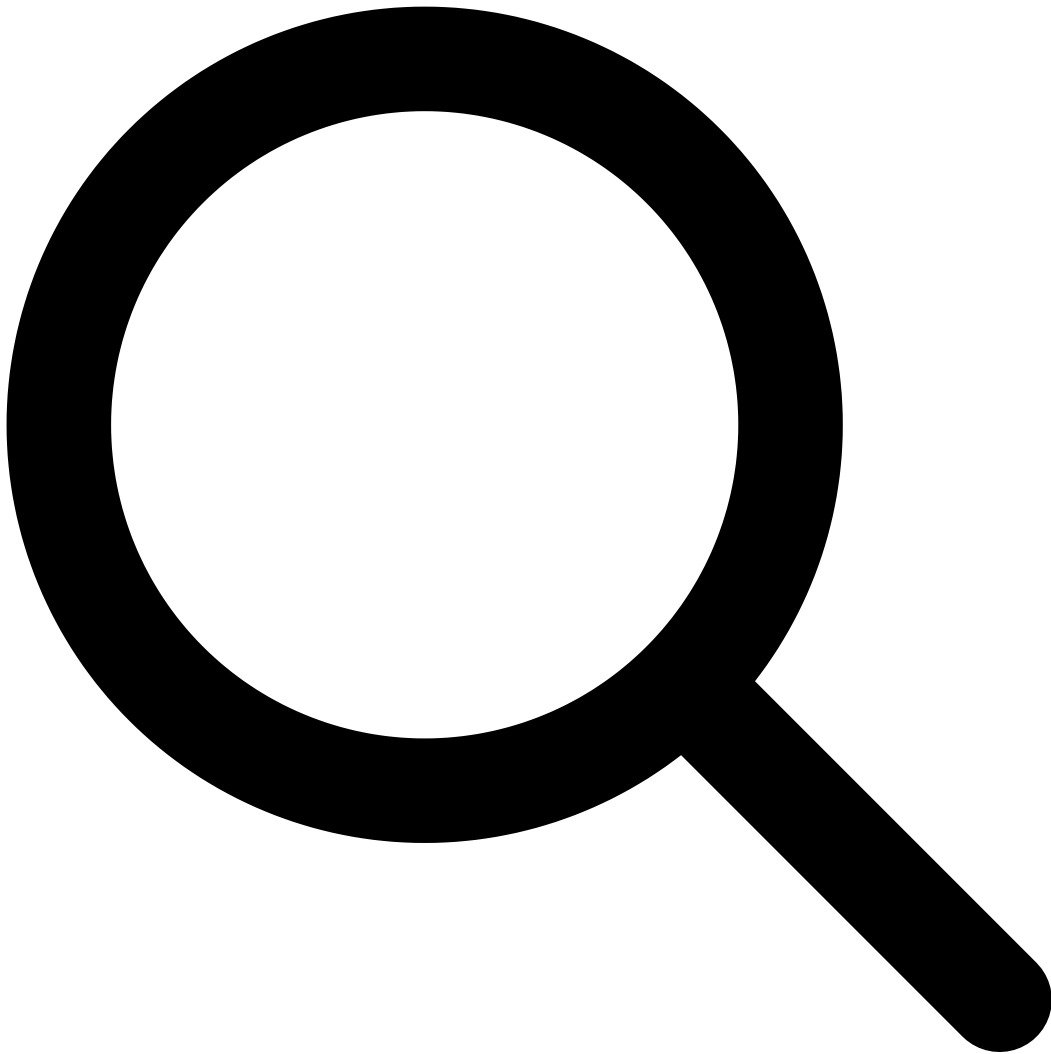


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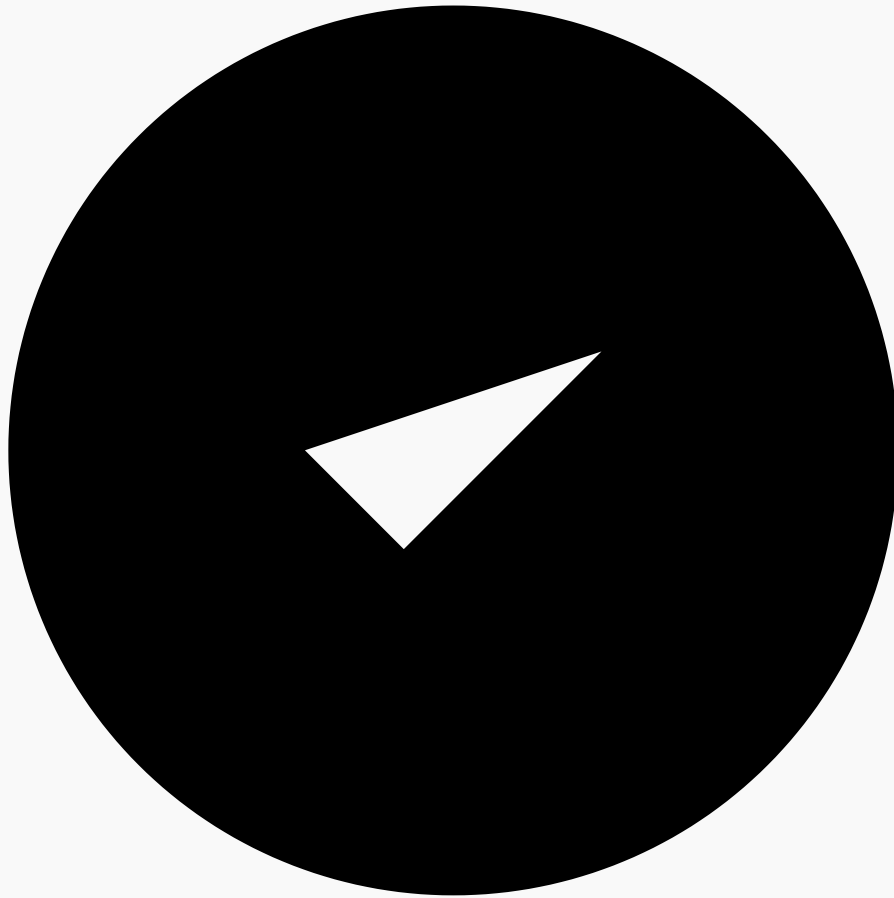
[Trevor Lam \(/\)](#)

Salon

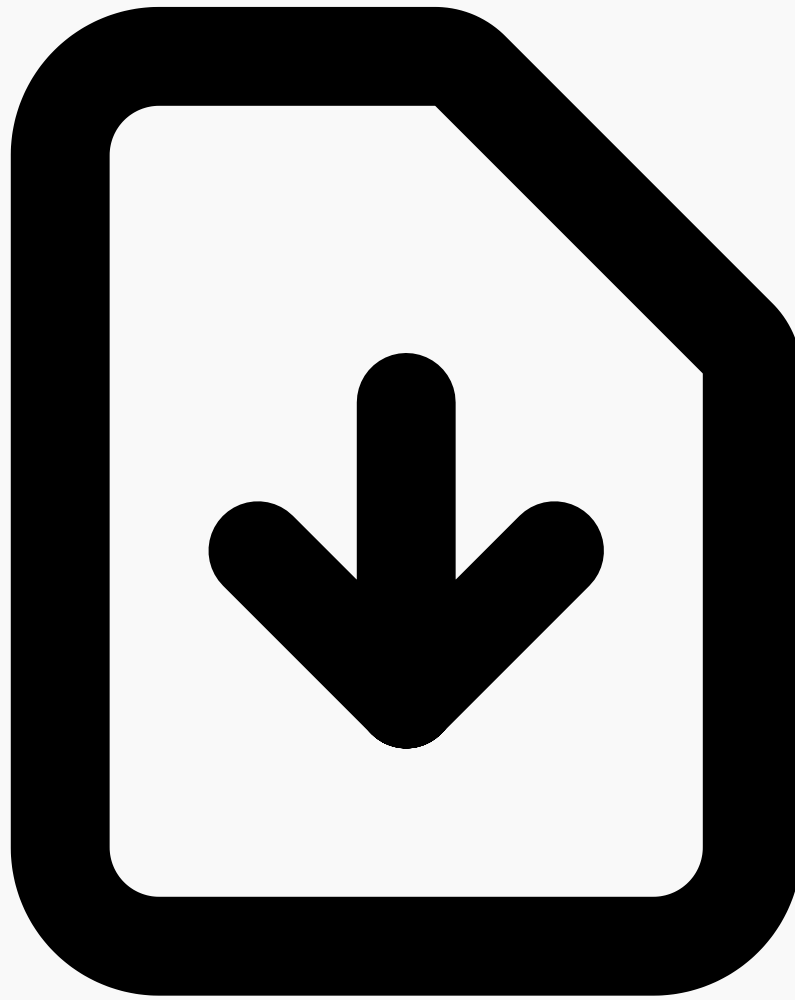
Grandlux Nail Salon: Precision Operations on a 17-Technician Commission Floor



Last updated: January 19, 2024



Case verified



Grandlux Nail Salon: Managing a 17-Person Commission Floor

Operational Context

I managed a 17-technician commission-based nail salon in McKinney, Texas. The job: handle unpredictable walk-ins, keep cash reconciliations perfect, and stop bad reviews before they happen.

Context: I took this role while finishing my UT Dallas degree (2021-2023). It was deliberate downtime after 12 intense years at Sonic—but I still kept my standards high.

Starting Point

- **17 commission-based technicians** with ego-driven, artist-mentality workforce
- **Unverified cash reconciliation** practices in high-volume cash environment
- **Reactive reputation management** — responding to complaints after departure
- **Variable-demand capacity** with unpredictable walk-in volume
- **Texas cosmetology compliance** requirements
- **Commission fairness disputes** — gross ticket splits, tip allocation

Confirmed Scope (and Limits)

Core Function:

- Floor management and real-time capacity optimization
- End-of-day cash reconciliation and controls
- Texas cosmetology sanitation and health regulation compliance
- Reputation management through proactive service recovery
- Technician pay fairness monitoring

Out of Scope:

- Inventory management (not part of this role)
- Social media management (not part of this role)
- Scheduling (not part of this role)

How I managed complex floor operations: Matched clients to technicians based on skill, availability, and service time—like hotel front desks or ER triage, but for manicures. Same problem: unpredictable demand, limited supply.

The Methodology

Phase 1: Cash Control Implementation

- Standardized end-of-day reconciliation procedures
- Commission tracking verification
- Gross ticket split validation
- Tip allocation documentation

Phase 2: Proactive Service Recovery

- Stayed on the floor, watched for unhappy body language
- Intercepted dissatisfied clients before they left
- Fixed issues in real-time
- Prevented bad Google reviews before they happened

Phase 3: Compliance Maintenance

- Texas cosmetology regulation adherence
- Sanitation protocol enforcement
- Documentation maintenance
- Health inspection readiness

The Outcome

Quantitative Results

- **Cash Discrepancies:** Zero across every end-of-day reconciliation (third time in my career I've hit perfect reconciliation)
- **Google Review Complaints:** Volume reduced through proactive service recovery
- **Compliance:** Texas cosmetology sanitation and health regulation maintained throughout tenure

Qualitative Impact

- Real-time capacity optimization achieved
- Technician commission fairness maintained
- Zero cash discrepancies in commission-based environment
- Proactive reputation management vs. reactive
- Showed I don't drop standards, even when the pressure's off

Skills Demonstrated

- **Financial Controls:** Zero-discrepancy end-of-day reconciliation in cash environment
- **Service Recovery:** Catching unhappy clients before they leave, not after
- **Capacity Optimization:** Matching supply and demand in real-time
- **Commission Management:** Fairness monitoring across technician workforce
- **Communication:** Managing creative personalities with big egos

What This Role Proved

This job showed I can:

- Keep perfect financial records across completely different industries
- Handle reputation management in real-time service environments
- Apply supply-and-demand principles to unpredictable walk-in businesses
- Adapt my approach for completely different workforces (fast-food teens to commissioned nail techs)
- Keep my standards high even when the role is 'just for now'
- Deliver the same results in my third completely different industry

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